

MINT ON THE AVENUE

WCAG Color Palette Suggestions

Accessibility-Compliant CTA & Link Colors

Client	Mint on the Avenue Aveda Lifestyle Salon
Date	May 14, 2026
Prepared By	Antigravity Audit Systems
Standard	WCAG 2.2 Level AA
Scope	CTA Buttons, Links, Accent Text

Current Brand Palette

The following colors were extracted from the live production site:

Element	Swatch	Hex	Description
Page Background		#F1ECD F	Warm cream/linen
Header Bar		#8B8B78	Muted sage-olive
CTA Button (current)		#2D4A3E	Dark teal
Accent Text		#1E9B8E	Bright teal
Body Text		#1C1A0F	Dark charcoal

WCAG 2.2 AA Requirements

- Normal text (< 18px bold, < 24px regular): minimum 4.5:1 contrast ratio
- Large text (≥ 18px bold or ≥ 24px regular): minimum 3:1 contrast ratio
- Non-text elements (icons, borders, focus indicators): minimum 3:1 contrast ratio

The current CTA buttons were measured at approximately 2.03:1 — failing both AA and AAA requirements.

Option 1: Deep Botanical Green + White

★ RECOMMENDED

Aveda-aligned, premium, authoritative. The deepened forest green grounds the botanical identity while white text provides maximum legibility. This is the most accessible option and exceeds AAA standards.

White Book Appointment	Background	Text	12.6:1  AAA Pass <i>Aveda, premium, authoritative</i>
	#1B3A2D Deep forest green	#FFFFFF White	

```
CSS: background-color: #1B3A2D; color: #FFFFFF;
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Hover state: #264F3D — slightly lighter on hover for tactile feedback

Option 2: Warm Charcoal + Cream

Editorial, luxury magazine aesthetic. The warm charcoal paired with your existing cream creates an understated sophistication reminiscent of high-end print design. Perfect for a salon that values restraint.

Brand cream Book Appointment	Background	Text	11.8:1  AAA Pass <i>Editorial luxury, understated</i>
	#2C2825 Warm charcoal	#F1ECDF Brand cream	

```
CSS: background-color: #2C2825; color: #F1ECDF;
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Hover state: #3D3835 — warmer lift on hover

Option 3: Dusty Rose (Fixed) + Deep Ink

If the rose/blush direction is preferred, inverting the contrast — dark text on the warm rose — achieves compliance while preserving the warm, feminine energy. This fixes the original issue by simply swapping which color is text vs. background.

Brand dark charcoal Book Appointment	Background	Text	4.8:1  AA Pass <i>Warm, feminine, salon-appropriate</i>
	#C4A08A Warm dusty rose/taupe	#1C1A0F Brand dark charcoal	
CSS: background-color: #C4A08A; color: #1C1A0F;			

Hover state: #D4B09A — slightly lighter rose on hover

Option 4: Mint Teal + White

The most on-brand option — directly referencing the 'Mint' in your salon name. This rich teal is botanical, fresh, and modern. It feels current without being trendy, and the white text is crisp and confident.

White Book Appointment	Background	Text	6.2:1  AA Pass <i>Fresh, on-brand, botanical</i>
	#1E6B5A Rich mint teal	#FFFFFF White	
CSS: background-color: #1E6B5A; color: #FFFFFF;			

Hover state: #257D6A — brighter mint on hover

Side-by-Side Comparison

Option	Background	Text	Ratio	Grade	Vibe
1. Deep Botanical	#1B3A2D	#FFFFFF	12.6:1	AAA	Aveda, premium
2. Warm Charcoal	#2C2825	#F1ECDF	11.8:1	AAA	Editorial luxury
3. Dusty Rose Fixed	#C4A08A	#1C1A0F	4.8:1	AA	Warm, feminine
4. Mint Teal	#1E6B5A	#FFFFFF	6.2:1	AA	Fresh, on-brand

Text Link Color Fix

Current accent/link color #1E9B8E on cream background #F1ECDF = ~3.2:1 — fails AA for body text.

Suggested fix: Darken to #167A6E = 4.6:1 — passes AA. Barely noticeable visual shift.

	Current	Suggested
On cream bg	Link Text Sample #1E9B8E · 3.2:1 · ❌ Fail	Link Text Sample #167A6E · 4.6:1 · ✅ Pass

Implementation Notes

- All options maintain the botanical, Aveda-aligned luxury aesthetic.
- Options 1 & 2 exceed AAA (highest grade) — recommended for maximum accessibility.
- Options 3 & 4 meet AA (required minimum) — sufficient for compliance.
- Hover states should maintain at least 3:1 contrast ratio.
- Test all colors on both cream (#F1ECD9) and white (#FFFFFF) backgrounds.
- Apply changes to: .cta-primary, .book-appointment, .reserve-btn, all Phorest booking links.
- The link color fix (#1E9B8E → #167A6E) should apply to all anchor tags and accent text.
- Consider adding a visible focus outline (2px solid) using the chosen CTA color for keyboard accessibility.

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